



MUNICH WAS A SCARY, HEARTBREAKING AND MOST UNFORTUNATE EVENT IN A MULTI-SPORT GAMES

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Harbinder Singh

The dream of every athlete is to win a medal at the Olympics. I also dreamt and lived it in my first appearance at the Olympics in 1964. At 18, I was the squad's youngest member, and we regained the gold lost to Pakistan in Rome, in 1964. Tokyo was special. The next, in Mexico, saw us finish with bronze. The result was the same four years later in Munich, but the memories of the Olympics left a scar on the game.

Munich was a scary, heartbreaking and most unfortunate event in a multi-sport Games. The Olympics came to be known for its Munich massacre. I still get shivers thinking of that black day when some athletes fell victim to mindless acts of terrorism.

I should not have been in Munich. I had announced my retirement from international hockey before the Olympics because I wanted some youngsters to come up. I remember this camp at the Shivaji Stadium where KD Singh 'Babu' watched me play the trial matches as inside-right. 'Babu' *saab* told our Railways manager Kishan Lal to convince me

to return to the team. My retirement plans were put on hold, and I was on the plane to Europe to play some matches before the Olympics.

We played Pakistan in the semifinals at the Olympics, and some goalkeeping errors cost us dear. We lost 0-2. Both goals came in the first-half. (Former Olympian) Gurbux Singh was a journalist at the



Eleven Israelis and five Palestinian attackers died after a gunfight. The competitions resumed after a day's mourning. We woke up to armymen taking over the Village and helicopters hovering in the sky.